announced their withdrawal on Sunday 28 October. During this time US citizens said more prayers and bought more handguns (and ten million of them evacuated their homes).[11] In various parts of Europe (including London) and South America there were public protests at Kennedy's actions (though not, it seems, at those of Khrushchev). Otherwise, people went about their daily routines. Life went on. *Monster Mash* was top of the US singles charts. In Perth MCC beat Western Australia by ten wickets. Alf Ramsey was appointed England football manager. Even at the height of the crisis, Leonid Brezhnev sneaked out of the Presidium to check how his football team (CSKA Moscow) was getting on.[12] Nikita Khrushchev made a point of dragging members of the Presidium off to the Bolshoi Theatre to watch an American production of *Boris Godunov.*

Harold Macmillan further observed that 'if you lived on Vesuvius, you don't much bother about eruptions'.[13] On 22 October 1962 just about everybody discovered they were living on Vesuvius, and just about everybody began bothering a great deal about eruptions.